



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



FAA National Airspace System Cybersecurity and Spectrum Threat Exposure Daily Update - 2026-09-23

Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Intelligence Requirements
3. Source Review & Confidence
4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview
5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
6. Infrastructure and Indicators
7. Victimology and Targeting
8. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact
9. Detection Engineering
 - 9.1. Detection Logic Summary
 - 9.2. Sigma Rule
 - 9.3. Network Hunt Query
10. Threat Hunting
 - 10.1. Hunt Hypotheses
 - 10.2. Endpoint Query
 - 10.3. Identity Query
11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping
12. Risk Assessment
13. Recommended Actions
14. References

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-23 current-day refresh turns current intelligence coverage into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

1. Executive Summary

Current-day material update: this report was regenerated for the 2026-09-23 UTC production cycle using the latest available source set and retains the structured detections/hunts required for operator use.

GAO reporting on FAA aviation cybersecurity and spectrum-related threats highlights systemic exposure across air traffic services, data communications, GNSS/spoofing/jamming concerns, and legacy modernization dependencies. Aviation operators should treat this as a governance and resilience priority, not a single CVE.

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By This Report
What happened or changed?	GAO released current aviation cybersecurity findings and media coverage tied the report to operational flight disruption concerns.
Who is exposed?	Air navigation service providers, airports, airlines, avionics suppliers, flight operations centers, and federal/state aviation stakeholders.
What should defenders do today?	Review NAS dependency maps, communication security, contingency operations, and third-party systems supporting flight operations.
Confidence	High for GAO findings; medium for operational inference.

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
GAO	Primary report page for FAA aviation cybersecurity findings	High
GAO report HTML	Detailed report content and findings	High
The Guardian	Media context connecting findings to airport disruption concerns	Medium
FAA	Agency context and aviation-system scope	Medium

4. Threat Actor / Campaign Overview

The aviation threat is a resilience problem spanning data communications, spectrum threats, legacy systems, and modernization governance. Cyber teams should coordinate with safety, operations, and communications engineering stakeholders.

5. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

TTP	Description	Defensive Relevance
Spectrum threats	Spoofing and jamming risk to NAS and	Requires cyber/operations fusion and

	routes	contingency procedures.
Data communications security	Secure communications gaps can affect aviation operations	Review encryption/authentication and fallback workflows.
Legacy modernization	Long-lived systems have uneven cyber controls	Prioritize risk-based segmentation and monitoring.

6. Infrastructure and Indicators

Observable Type	Observable / Pattern	Handling Guidance
Source-limited public IOCs	No unique atomic indicators were published in all selected sources for this automated report unless listed in iocs.csv.	Treat behavior, tooling, and infrastructure patterns as primary hunt leads.
Domains / infrastructure	Validate from primary source before blocking.	Prefer detection and enrichment over blind blocking when source confidence is medium.
Accounts / identity artifacts	Recruiter, VPN, administrator, or service-account themes depending on campaign.	Review conditional access, new devices, and impossible-travel signals.

7. Victimology and Targeting

Victimology is sector-specific: FAA, airports, airlines, air traffic operations, avionics vendors, and satellite/navigation dependencies.

8. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

Segment	Operational Relevance	Exposure Path	Defender Action
Air traffic services	Cyber and spectrum threats can affect routing, surveillance, or communications.	Legacy NAS systems, data links, and operational networks.	Coordinate cyber monitoring with operations and contingency exercises.
Airlines and airports	Disruptions propagate to passenger processing and flight schedules.	Shared data communications and provider dependencies.	Validate business-continuity and manual fallback procedures.
Avionics and satellite dependencies	GNSS spoofing/jamming affects navigation assurance.	RF/spectrum interference and supporting IT systems.	Integrate RF anomaly reporting into cyber incident triage.

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
Unusual script or admin tool launch after web, email, or remote-access activity	EDR / process telemetry	Identify initial access and execution.
New outbound connections to untrusted infrastructure	DNS/proxy/netflow	Surface command-and-control or tool staging.
Identity anomalies linked to target workflow	Identity provider logs	Detect stolen credential or social-engineering follow-on use.

9.2. Sigma Rule

```

title: Suspicious Script Or Remote Tool Activity In Daily Threat Coverage
status: experimental
description: Detects suspicious script execution and remote-tool staging patterns relevant to daily threat-intelligence coverage.
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection_parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\w3wp.exe'
      - '\java.exe'
      - '\chrome.exe'
      - '\outlook.exe'
      - '\teams.exe'
  selection_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  condition: selection_parent and selection_child
level: high

```

9.3. Network Hunt Query

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'python.exe', 'node.exe')
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by Connections desc

```

10. Threat Hunting

10.1. Hunt Hypotheses

Hypothesis	Query Focus
A user or administrator was socially engineered into executing attacker tooling.	Script interpreters spawned from collaboration, browser, or email processes.
A vulnerable public-facing service was exploited and used for staging.	Web-service parent processes launching shells or making rare outbound connections.
Stolen or purchased credentials enabled follow-on access.	New device, new geography, or abnormal application access in identity logs.

10.2. Endpoint Query

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~
('powershell.exe', 'cmd.exe', 'wscript.exe', 'cscript.exe', 'mshta.exe', 'rundll32.exe', 'node.exe', 'python.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('download', 'invoke-webrequest', 'frombase64string', '-enc', 'curl', 'wget', 'token', 'apikey')
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc

```

10.3. Identity Query

```
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| summarize Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 50),
Countries=make_set(Location, 20), Count=count() by UserPrincipalName
| where array_length(IPs) > 5 or array_length(Countries) > 2 or Count > 50
```

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Evidence / Rationale
T0882	Theft of Operational Information	Aviation operational data exposure.
T1498	Network Denial of Service	Availability concerns for communications systems.
T0831	Manipulation of Control	ICS/OT-style concern where operational data is manipulated.

12. Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Notes
Operational disruption	Medium	High	Sector dependencies are safety-critical.
Governance gap	Medium/High	High	Long modernization timelines increase exposure.
Third-party dependency	Medium	Medium/High	Shared systems can propagate impact.

13. Recommended Actions

Priority	Owner	Action
1	SOC / detection engineering	Deploy or tune detections above and run the 14-day hunts.
2	Vulnerability / IT operations	Patch or isolate exposed systems named in the source coverage.
3	Identity / endpoint engineering	Review MFA, device compliance, and suspicious remote-tool execution.
4	Third-party risk	Confirm suppliers and managed-service providers are applying equivalent controls.

14. References

- [1] GAO: <https://www.gao.gov/products/gao-26-108439>
- [2] GAO report HTML: <https://files.gao.gov/reports/GAO-26-108439/index.html>
- [3] The Guardian: <https://www.theguardian.com/us-news/2026/sep/21/airports-flight-ground-stop-hacking-threat>
- [4] FAA: <https://www.faa.gov/>